

Zhuoran (Jolia) Chen

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Education

New York University Shanghai

Expected Graduation: May
2026

Major: Computer Science

GPA: 3.948/4.00 (Major GPA: 4.00/4.00)

Publications

Ademi Adeniji*, **Zhuoran Chen***, Vincent Liu, Venkatesh Pattabiraman, Raunaq Bhirangi, Siddhant Haldar, Pieter Abbeel, Lerrel Pinto.

Feel the Force: Contact-Driven Learning from Humans.

Accepted at RSS Workshop, 2025. [\[Project Page\]](#)

arXiv preprint, arXiv:2506.01944, June 2025. (* equal contribution)

Xinqi Lucas Liu*, Ruoxi Hu*, Alejandro Ojeda Olarte, **Zhuoran Chen**, Kenny Ma, Charles Cheng Ji, Lerrel Pinto, Raunaq Bhirangi, Irmak Guzey.

RUKA-v2: Tendon-Driven Open-Source Dexterous Hand with Wrist and Abduction for Robot Learning.

Under review. [\[Project Page\]](#)

arXiv preprint, arXiv:2603.26660, March 2026. (* equal contribution)

Yuanhe Guo*, Linxi Xie*, **Zhuoran Chen**, Kangrui Yu, Ryan Po, Guandao Yang, Gordon Wetzstein, Hongyi Wen.

ImageGem: In-the-Wild Generative Image Interaction Dataset for Generative Model Personalization.

Accepted at IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV), 2025. [\[Project Page\]](#)

arXiv preprint, arXiv:2510.18433, October 2025. (* equal contribution)

Research Experience

Research Assistant Advisor: [Shengjie Wang](#)

Sep 2025 – Present

NYU Shanghai – Shanghai, China

Ongoing Project: Injecting in-context learning into vision-language-action models for long-horizon robotic tasks

Research Assistant Advisor: [Lerrel Pinto](#)

Dec 2024 – Aug 2025

NYU – New York, USA, Generalizable Robotics and AI Lab (GRAIL)

Project: Feel the Force

- Co-first author of *Feel the Force*, a framework for learning force-sensitive manipulation from human tactile demonstrations, featuring a tactile-glove data collection pipeline and a Transformer-based closed-loop policy that achieved 77% success across five manipulation tasks.

Project: RUKA-v2

- Built a real-time teleoperation system that mapped human arm and hand motion to a Franka arm with the RUKA robotic hand through Meta Quest.

Research Assistant Advisor: [Hongyi Wen](#)

Jan 2024 – May 2025

NYU Shanghai – Shanghai, China, Multimodal Accessible Personalization Systems (MAPS) research group

Project: ImageGem

- Second author of *ImageGem*; built a personalized image retrieval and generative-model recommendation pipeline using collaborative filtering followed by visual-language-model reranking.

Project: Human-in-the-Loop Image Generation

- Conducted a user study on how human intervention shapes image-generation quality and controllability.
- Designed an evaluation interface with an ELO-style rating system, enabling users to assess image alignment and creativity before and after human fine-tuning.

Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant**, NYU Shanghai Mar 2026 – Present
- Supported instruction for *Artificial Intelligence for Business* in the MSDABC program through course assistance and student guidance.
- Learning Assistant**, NYU Shanghai Jan 2026 – Present
- Mentored students in *Data Structures* and *Introduction to Computer Programming*, providing debugging support and problem-solving guidance.

Awards and Honors

Georgia Robotics Fellowship, 2026
China National Scholarship, 2025
NYU Shanghai Recognition Award, 2025
Outstanding Capstone Poster Award, 2025
Dean Undergraduate Research Funding, 2023 and 2024
Dean's Honors List, 2023–2025

Course Projects

- Style Unlearning: Parameter-Efficient Modules for Efficient Style Removal**, NYU Fall 2024
Professor Saining Xie, Computer Vision (Graduate-level)
- Compared the Weights2Weights (W2W) framework against Negation of LoRA for parameter-efficient style unlearning, confirming W2W's consistent style suppression verified by CLIP and VLM metrics.
- Computer Graphics Final Project**, NYU Fall 2024
Professor Ken Perlin, Computer Graphics (Graduate-level)
- Developed an interactive 3D graphics web application using raw WebGL, implementing 3D modeling, animation, real-time rendering, and user interaction. [\[Project Demo Video\]](#)
- Evaluation Methods on Text Summarization**, NYU Shanghai Spring 2024
Professor Chen Zhao, Natural Language Processing
- Evaluated text summarization methods for dialogue and academic articles using GPT-3.5 and GPT-4 with both reference-based metrics (ROUGE, BERTScore) and reference-free evaluation (GPT-4, human assessment).
- Audio Classification using Deep Learning Models**, NYU Shanghai Spring 2024
Professor Yik-Cheung Tam, Machine Learning
- Built an end-to-end audio classification pipeline by extracting spectral features (Mel spectrograms, MFCCs), applying data augmentation, and training deep CNN-based models (Inception, Densenet, ResNet) to achieve 79.6% test accuracy.
- Multi-function Chat System with GUI Integration**, NYU Shanghai Fall 2023
Professor Xianbin Gu, Introduction to Computer Science and Data Science
- Developed an integrated chat system with a graphical user interface that replaced command-based inputs and improved usability. [\[Project Demo Video\]](#)
 - Built a login system with password validation, account creation, and secure user management backed by serialized storage.
 - Integrated RSA encryption for secure messaging and added chat history search, message points, and connection management.
 - Implemented a PyGame-based Flappy Bird module with score ranking and storage, using multithreading to keep gameplay independent from the chat system.

Leadership, Service, and Community Engagement

- Information Assistant and Project Leader**, Academic Resource Center, China Jan – Dec 2023
- Led the design and execution of the Interview Project to promote peer academic support, directing students to utilize academic mentoring and tutoring services.

Campus Ambassador, PwC China

March – Dec 2023

- Organized and promoted 10+ recruiting events and managed a 400+ member career group, expanding student access to internship opportunities and ranking in the Top 10 KPI performers in South China.

Member, StarIntern Initiative, China

Feb – May 2023

- Helped build a student career community from 0 to 245 members and established 20+ startup partnerships to deliver mentorship and career-development programs.

Volunteer, Turtle Conservation and Education Center, Bali

June 2023

- Supported marine conservation through beach cleanup, environmental data collection, and sea turtle care.
- Classified field data and assisted with sea turtle rehabilitation.
- Taught local children about marine protection through interactive activities.

Teaching Tutor, Stepping Stone Program, China

Sep 2022 – May 2023

- Volunteered weekly to teach programming to primary school students at local community centers, broadening access to foundational computing education.

Volunteer, Dean's Service Corps – Elderly Care Team, China

Sep – Dec 2022

- Designed and led interviews with elderly residents to assess their needs in the AI era, then synthesized the findings into an advocacy video promoting human-centered care and digital inclusion.

Skills

Python, C, PyTorch, ROS, OpenCV, Git, Linux, Streamlit, HTML/CSS/JS, Docker, Research Design, Mentoring

Interests

Basketball, running, badminton, hurdling, painting

Languages

English (Fluent), Cantonese (Native), Mandarin (Native)